

TEACHING TIPS:

- This is a **bouncy**, happy song, so try to reflect this in your singing style, particularly in the verses.
- Contrast this with a smoother, more **lyrical style** on 'spring has sprung', 'blooming bright' and 'new has come' in the choruses.
- Watch out for the **syncopated rhythm** on 'they're' and 'me' in verse 1 (and in the corresponding places in verses 2 and 3).
- Notice there's no 'And' on the penultimate line of verse 3, which is different to earlier in the verse – so it's just 'Everywhere 'round us there's life to be found'.

WHAT YOU NEED

A good sense of pulse; untuned percussion e.g. claves, guiros, shakers

LISTEN

Listen to the bass line played by the left hand of the pianist in *New Orleans Blues* by Jelly Roll Morton, which features the tresillo rhythm.
www.youtube.com/watch?v=k24fD36Zurk

LOOK

For more about the origin of the 'tresillo' rhythm and some more contemporary examples, watch www.youtube.com/watch?v=DZ_yT_ukKKA&t=53s. It's a bit long to play in its entirety but you might want to play some short clips to the children.

Notation

Improvise

Sing

Listen

Play

Compose

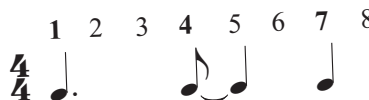
Genre/History/Musicians

ACTIVITY

AGES 7 - 11 

Syncopated percussion

Listen carefully to the backing track. See if the children can clap along with the following **syncopated rhythm**, which emphasizes quaver beats 1, 4 and 7 of the bar:



This is also known as a 3 + 3 + 2 or 'tresillo' rhythm, which is the rhythm that gets your toes tapping and hips swaying in Latin American music. See if the children can gently move from one foot to the other on beats 1 and 3 of the bar (or beats 1 and 5 if you are counting in quavers) as they clap along with the track.

Now transfer this rhythm to various untuned percussion instruments such as claves, guiros and shakers to **create a rhythmic accompaniment** to the verses of the song.

WHAT'S ACHIEVABLE?

To explore tresillo rhythm.
To clap along in time with the song.
To perform a percussion accompaniment.

RHYTHM

Duration/length of notes; regular, repeated patterns of sound

TEXTURE

Layers of rhythm and sound